

Inventory Discrepancy - Part MMF0005531 (Findings)

Investigated: 2026-09-02 | **Part:** MMF0005531 (Sheet, .312 x 60 x 120)

The Short Answer

The missing **21,091 lb** is not actually lost and is not a transfer problem. It is **steel that was issued to three work orders that never ran (or never finished).**

When steel is issued to a work order, the system takes it off the "on hand" count right away. But the steel physically stays on the floor until the job actually uses it. If the job never runs, the system thinks the steel is gone while it is still sitting there. A physical floor count sees it. The system's on-hand number does not.

What The System Shows

- The system says we only have **12,451 lb** of this part, and it is **all in S-00** (staging).
- The work center (WC), T-00, RECV, and every other location show **zero**.
- If we add your 21,091 lb difference, the physical floor has about **33,542 lb**.

What We Think Happened

- The system's own records are correct and add up perfectly (everything that came in minus everything that went out equals the 12,451 lb on hand). Nothing is hidden or deleted.
- The gap is **work-in-process steel**: roughly **21,500 lb was issued to work orders that are still open**, so it was removed from the system count but never turned into parts.

The Three Work Orders Holding The Material

Work Order	Status	Pieces Done	Steel Issued	When Issued
WO-073062	Open	0 of 59	12,980 lb	Aug 4

Work Order	Status	Pieces Done	Steel Issued	When Issued
WO-073820	Open	0 of 76	4,447 lb	Sep 1
WO-073063	Open	402 of 413	4,116 lb	Aug 4 - 5
			Total: 21,543 lb	

The total (21,543 lb) is within about 450 lb (less than one sheet) of your 21,091 lb difference. The small leftover is just the small amount WO-073063 already used up (it is 97% complete but not yet closed).

Most likely spot to look first: WO-073062 has **12,980 lb of steel and has not made a single piece in a full month** (since Aug 4). That steel is almost certainly what is on the floor making the count high.

Why It Is Not The Transfers

You asked us to check location-to-location transfers (the Out + In pairs). We checked every one of them in the system:

- Every transfer is a clean, matched Out/In pair that nets to zero.
- None of the transfer pairs are broken or half-finished.
- Transfers are **not** causing the difference.

What We Ruled Out

- **No missing receipt:** every recent delivery is fully booked in the system. The open purchase orders show zero received, which means those trucks have not arrived yet.
- **No system math error:** the system's lifetime records add up exactly to the on-hand balance.
- **No half-finished transfers** (see above).

What To Do Next

1. **Go look at WO-073062 and WO-073820 on the floor.** Is the issued steel actually sitting at the work center? Both jobs show 0 pieces done.
2. **If a job is not going to run, return the unused steel** in the system (do a work-order return). That puts the steel back on the on-hand count and clears most of the gap.

3. **Close out WO-073063** (it is 97% done) and return any leftover piece.
4. **Change the habit going forward:** do not issue a whole job's steel until the job is about to run, and return unused steel the same day. This is the same "Out then In" discipline used for transfers, applied to work-order issues.

Note: There is also one odd single entry - a **634 lb** removal from the work center on Aug 21 with no work order, no receipt, and no transfer behind it. It is small, but worth checking separately.